

EPISODE 23 (SESSION 1)

Falling on Joyful Faces

PRIMARY TEXT: EXODUS 24–40

There's something about rhythms. Rhythms of creation and life and song. How the seasons of creation paint for us images of rebirth, of harvest, of work, and of rest. Throughout this beautiful Story, we are shown in more ways than one what it could look like to lean into these divine patterns—to Trust the Story.

Yet, so very often, we don't.

There's something about the idea of being an invitation—a walking invitation to God and His Kingdom. Oftentimes in the Western church the invitation to God is made, and then we carry on with our separate lives. But in the Text, this invitation isn't just a one-time conversation that happens to “save souls.” This looks a whole lot more like a score card than the images at Sinai in Exodus where we see an active invitation—mobile, fluid-like. Maybe it's a lot more like the wind. A cool breeze that comes in our dry desert moments. A lot like the *ruach* God breathed into humankind in the first place, inviting us, and our neighbors, to the most restful and celebratory place of meeting we could possibly imagine.

Yet, so often, we forget to be that *invitation* to our neighbors—to put God on display in our daily lives and sacred stations so that others can be moved by Him through us.

In all honesty, sabbath this week felt like a nuisance instead of a gifted rhythm. The week was busy, filled with so many good things, and I didn't have my usual (and needed) time, to prepare to rest for a day. So I fought it. Fought sabbath—not *for* sabbath. I fought sabbath. What a ridiculous notion; but am I that alone in my foolish audacity?

I felt the need, the pull in my soul to rest, but I still fought it. I finally found myself sitting on the porch. The sun was beginning its descent. The daisies were beginning to open. The raspberries were turning a brilliant shade of red, and the trees of the giant willow waved gently, in a rhythm. Back and forth, back and forth. Mesmerized, I watched. My breath suddenly keeping time, and I felt it, finally—rest, peace, joy. I may not have recognized when to stop. Stop overcreating and overworking, but God brought me back to this promise by planting me in the rhythms He's set in motion and in time all around us.

**I felt it,
finally—rest,
peace, joy.**

**We are shown what it
could look like to lean
into these divine patterns.**

I missed you, God. And my heart aches. And my anxiety is growing and my head hurts... And, I'm just so tired. How can I continue to be an invitation to you and your Kingdom, when, apparently, I seem to have “lost” it myself this week?

Now the crickets chimed into this pace of my heart, my soul, my *very*, and my sweet elderly dog put her graying head on my leg in comfort.

I know; I missed you too. But I was there. And I'm still here. You can't lose an invitation when it's been poured out on you, imprinted on your soul. I'm here, My presence, always, here to fill you with life and joy. I'm not angry.

And there it was. There it is. Falling on my face in joy, in peace, in so much gratitude. That I don't have to fear God on my worst days. On my broken sabbaths or in my unfulfilled promises.

And neither do you.

We've learned throughout this journey through the Text together that God wants us.

He wants you.

He's created you and called you and laid His Spirit upon you to invite the world to the greatest celebration we could imagine in the most breathtaking of meeting places.

I imagine it's designed with seasons and rhythms. Painted with sunsets raining down like fire. Wildflowers dancing in the wind and birds whistling and crickets chirping—all under a tent of slow and steady clouds.

***You can't lose
an invitation
when it's been
poured out on
you...***

PRAYER

God of creation,

*We're grateful for the way Your presence
hovers over us always, never out of reach.*

*For the reminders of how to rest
and for meeting us in all seasons.*

*We're in awe of Your glory
brought to our knees not in fear—but adoration
of Your enduring love.*

May we be walking invitations to You.

Models of the rhythms of sabbath and celebration.

*May Your presence continue to go before us,
and may we always yearn to be in that sacred space
with You.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 23

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

What might be important to meditate over within these chapters of Exodus? What part of this Text challenges you or could you dig deeper into?



COMMUNITY

How does your community seek to be God's walking invitation to Him? How might you better model seasons and rhythms for each other and the world around you?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from the reminder of God's near and constant presence? Who needs to see God's invitation to rest and joy through your life? Who can you bring along on this journey through the Text, and the desert, with you?



WRESTLING

What are you wrestling with? What is unsettling or confusing about Sinai, the Tent of Meeting, and the connections with the Temple and even Pentecost? Where else might you see images of fire and wind and clouds representing God's presence? Remember—wrestling is good!



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

*What spiritual practices or disciplines might you need to connect with God? We believe that **if we do our part in creating space for God, He will fill it.** How might the smallest practice fill you with more of Him to be that representation of Him? Where in your life do you have that place, or time, of meeting with Him? How have you created space to hear God speak to, challenge, or hold you? Time of prayer, fasting, meditation, worship, etc. What space can you enter into that may make you fall to your face in joy?*

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

***We believe young adults are shaping the future,** and they need to be shown by people such as you what living in His Spirit looks like. To trust the Story, to love God with all their being, and to be a walking invitation and image of the Kingdom on earth. Young adults need to not just hear but see how our God is different and that He is present with them, always. What young adults near you could you be this invitation to?*

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

*Living like Jesus and being his mobile invitation to join Him in the Tent of Meeting isn't just meant for Sunday mornings or Bible study; it's about living like Him in our everyday lives. How might you put this call—this invitation—of God on display in how you pursue and experience your 9–5? Does your physical work put you in a position to be a walking image of God's love, God's promise? Do you model healthy seasons and rhythms and help foster them in others? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products should show God's love for us, our love for Him, and how He's always with us. **You are doing a sacred work—no matter where you are.** Do it so that it reflects the rhythms and promises God has created for us.*